

ONE MAN'S OPINION

Incompetent Umpiring Raises
Furor Around the Southern

By RAYMOND JOHNSON



Frank Girard, grandpappy of Prexy Charlie Hurth's Blind Toms, blew a play in the first game in Sulphur Dell Sunday and it cost Matt Batts, Nashville catcher . . . Matt was put out of the game for disputing the decision and chances are that Girard recommended a suspension to his boss for Matt's actions.

Girard will never admit he blew the play . . . But pictures made by one of this paper's photographers leave no doubt about it . . . Dick Barone ran out of the base paths in attempting to elude Batts, who insisted that he touched the speedy Pelican . . . Barone never touched home plate, either.

Bill Melvin, Girard's partner, and Frank were in hot water on more than one occasion during the two games, just as they were the previous Sunday here . . . Andy Cohen, New Orleans manager, wasn't happy over several calls . . . Neither was Phil Page, Birmingham's skipper, the previous Sunday.